

Steven Jia

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SUMMARY

Graduate Data and AI Engineer with a Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and a Minor in Artificial Intelligence. Currently working at Ocular with PHP, Laravel, PostgreSQL, multi-tenant data models, REST APIs, search, caching, queues, storage, and service integration. Practical experience in Python, SQL, data preparation, machine learning, NLP, computer vision, model evaluation, and software testing. Interested in reliable data systems, AI applications, backend services, automation, and cloud deployment.

EDUCATION

Victoria University of Wellington

2023-2025

Bachelor of Science - Computer Science, Minor in Artificial Intelligence

Relevant study: Machine Learning, Databases, Data Structures, Software Engineering, Network Systems, Human-Computer Interaction

EXPERIENCE

Full Stack Developer

Jul 2026-Present

Ocular

- Develop and maintain multi-tenant web application features using Vue 3, TypeScript, Inertia.js, PHP, Laravel, and PostgreSQL.
- Build end-to-end workflows across Vue components, Inertia requests, Laravel routes, middleware, controllers, Eloquent models, validation, and database migrations.
- Contribute to REST API and service integrations covering authentication and authorisation, search, file storage, email, document generation, queues, and real-time features.
- Work in a Docker and Laravel Sail environment with Ziggy, Laravel Precognition, Valkey, Meilisearch, Reverb, MinIO, Spatie Media Library, Gotenberg, Mailpit, auditing, and versioning.

Coding and Robotics Tutor

Jan 2024-Present

Scots College

- Deliver programming and robotics sessions using Python and robotics platforms for students with varied experience levels.
- Support debugging, testing, structured problem solving, and step-by-step technical learning.
- Guide robotics competition preparation, including RoboCup, while building strong communication and mentoring skills.

PC and Mobile Phone Repair Technician

Dec 2025-Feb 2026

UR Tech

- Diagnosed hardware and software faults across computers, mobile phones, and electronic devices.
- Installed and configured operating systems, completed device setup, data transfers, updates, and quality checks.
- Explained technical issues clearly to customers and recommended practical, reliable solutions.

PROJECTS

Handwritten Character Recognition | Python, CNN, Vision Transformer

- Prepared and processed image datasets, trained CNN and Vision Transformer models, and compared model behaviour and performance trade-offs.
- Evaluated incorrect predictions and adjusted preprocessing and training decisions using structured error analysis.
- Published a live project demo and used Git-based and AI-assisted workflows for planning, debugging, code review, and validation.

AG News Text Classification | Python, NLP, Machine Learning

- Built and evaluated traditional machine learning, CNN-based, and transformer-based models for news category prediction.
- Prepared training and testing data and compared accuracy and class-level performance metrics across approaches.

Data-Oriented Software Testing | Java, JUnit, Git

- Designed unit tests to detect software issues early and improve reliability in a team-based application.
- Built a simple fuzz testing tool to repeatedly run the application and identify unexpected behaviours and edge cases.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming and Data: Python, SQL, PHP, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, data cleaning, data processing, structured data handling

Data and AI: Classification models, CNNs, Vision Transformers, NLP, feature preparation, model evaluation, accuracy, F1 score, error analysis

Application Data Systems: PostgreSQL, Eloquent ORM, multi-tenancy, Valkey, Meilisearch, REST APIs, Laravel Queue, auditing, versioning

Platforms and Tools: Laravel, Docker, Laravel Sail, MinIO, Spatie Media Library, Gotenberg, Mailpit, Git, GitHub, Jupyter, Google Colab, AWS Cloud fundamentals

CERTIFICATIONS AND ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner - 2026

VUW Git and GitHub Workshop - 2024

Full New Zealand Driver Licence | Eligible to work in New Zealand | Open to relocation